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Glossary

stormed	-	sudden violent attack
Ratisbon	-	(German Regensburg) a city in Austria
mound	-	hillock/ hill
out-thrust	-	extended forward
fancy	-	imagine
prone	-	inclined downward
oppressive	-	harsh, domineering
mused	-	thought deeply
Lannes	-	Duke of Montebello, a general in Napoleon's army.
bridle	-	the head gear used to control a horse
compressed	-	pressed together
anon	-	soon
flag-bird	-	the imperial eagle on the French flag
perched	-	sat on, rested
sheathes	-	covers

1. Fill in the blanks choosing the words from the box given and complete the summary of the poem.

The poet Robert Browning narrates an incident at the French Camp in the war of 1809 between France and Austria, in a (a)_____version. He describes the brave action of a (b) _____soldier, whose heroic devotion to duty and his (c) _____ in it is inspiring and worthy of (d) _____.

During the attack of the French army on Ratisbon, Napoleon was anxious about the (e) _____. Austrians were defending Ratisbon with great (f) _____and courage. Napoleon was watching the war standing on a (g) _____near the battlefield.

All of a sudden a rider appeared from the closed smoke and dust. Riding at great speed, jumping and leaping, he approached the mound where Napoleon stood. As he came closer, the narrator noticed that the rider, a young boy, was severely wounded. But the rider showed no sign of pain and smiling in joy, jumped off the horse and gave the happy news of (h) _____ to the emperor.

He exclaimed with pride that the French had (i) _____ Ratisbon and he himself had hoisted the flag of France. When Napoleon heard the news, his plans (j) _____ up like fire. His eyes (k) _____ when he saw that the soldier was severely wounded. Like a caring mother eagle, the emperor asked if he was wounded. The (l) _____ soldier replied proudly that he was killed and died heroically.

determination	result	dramatic
pride	admiration	softened
wounded	mound	victory
conquered	soared	valiant

2. Based on your understanding of the poem, answer the following questions in one or two sentences each.

a. Who do you think is the narrator of the poem?
b. Where was the narrator when the incident happened?
c. Who took the city of Ratisbon by storm?
d. Where was Napoleon standing on the day of attack on the city of Ratisbon?
e. Describe the posture of Napoleon.
f. Who came galloping on a horse to Napoleon?

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